November 18, 2025 - 6:30 pm
School Council Meeting Minutes

Google Meet link: meet.google.com/dwi-suyj-rph

Chicopee Hills School Council Bylaws

A. Welcome (Erica)

- See **Attachment 1** for attendance
- October minutes Approved

B. School Update (Jenni)

- See **Attachment 2** for school update
- Supplementary notes:
  - Nov 19th – another high school presentations- FI at KCI, extended French at Grand River or come out of FI and go to Grand River; tomorrow will hear from KCI FI program and next week will hear from Grand River extended French program
  - Intermediate volleyball teams – had two parents volunteers to come in to run workshops
  - Primary kindness club -so popular that it was divided into two sections
  - Medial club continues – did holiday market posters
  - Two choirs that are practicing - Jr Kadia Choir (gr 5/6) and Holiday singers – taking a group to sing at Fairway Park mall tree lightening this week
  - Ms. Guy – Working on proposal for end of year Gr8 trip; 2 days one night with a Ballgame; waiting on superintendent approval; once approved, will have a parent info night

Upcoming

- This Friday Nov 20th – French presentation – The Three Musketeers; supported by parent council
- Intermediate – Jr achievement career hunt; part of guidance curriculum for gr 7/8
- Week of giving Dec 8-12th ; doing many of the same charities as last time - house of friendship turkey drive, food drive for foodbank, starling youth services, comfy cozy campaign (for children living in youth shelter system); also participating in CTV toy mountain
- Dec 9th – Sources of strength presentation for Gr 7 (waterloo region suicide prevention presentation)

C. HOT TOPIC - (Jenni and Chris)

Words Matter campaign

- Challenging harmful and discriminatory language un our K-12 school communities
- Discussing the impact of discretionary language, in the schools, on student well-being,
- Teaching kids that words matter and using their words for good
- Handouts for parents and caregivers to reinforce the conversation at home
- Mapping exercise- where your child may be exposed to harmful and discriminatory language
- Think about next steps? Where are the areas of most concern? What areas do we have more or less control of? Which area do you feel the most confidence in talking to your child about this?
- These conversations are happening at school based on age appropriateness for students and the teachers have been working on these discussions for the past 2 years to help support the students in these discussions

Topic for Next Meeting?

- EQAO results

D. Financial Update (Martin)

School Council Fund = $16,169.94

a. WEFI = $9,656.28
   i. $ 8,097.80 (Outdoor Learning)
   ii. $ 1,558.48 (General)
b. Factory Shoe = $1,195.00
c. Mabel's Labels = $ --

d. Current staff requests for purchases
    1. PE department – utility cart; $295 each x 2 units
        - First Kat, second Erika
        - **Approved by all**, none opposed
    2. Gr 7/8 science teacher – button maker and supplies for buttons; Cost $250
        - First Kat, Second Erika
        - **Approved by all**, non opposed
    3. Ms. Rumple (language teacher) – headphones for reading intervention program; $250
        - First Martin, second Erika
        - **Approved by all**, none opposed

E. Fundraising & Events Update (Erica/Jenni)

Holiday Market

- Saturday, December 6 - 11 am - 3 pm
- 57 vendors
- In need of tables for the event; may need to look into renting more tables
- Roadside sign – unable to get a permit to put up a sign
- Banners for event $225, will come out of vendor fees
- In need of volunteers – starting at 9 am for set up/ tear down
- Event posted on community boards
- To print half sheet fliers to hand out to students
- No bake sale this year

Poinsettias

- Had 106 purchased; only 63 ordered from the school; reminders ordered by Stanley Park Community Centre; numbers were down this year;
- Will assess how much we made from this event and will re-assess to do it again next year
- To make an effort to tell parents what we are fundraising for – that might help drive sales

Pizza Nights

- Only option at this point is Domino's
- Suggestion to table until determine what we are fundraising for in January

Media Club

- Steady stream of kids

- Next project - week of giving posters

Science Fair

- Headed up by Mme Pandell
- Questions is when to do the Science Fair
- Kids need 2-3 month lead time – supposed to be January 22nd but would like to push it back 1-2 weeks later
- Moved to Feb 5th
- Ideally in next few weeks get form out to students and can get them poster boards for the break and all of January to be working on the project
- Suggestion to pay for poster boards so no child has to pay for their own board
- Need volunteers the day of for set up
- Set it up for the whole day, then keep it up in the evening for family's to visit
- One page form that the students fill out; the students can request needs for their presentation; deadline would be before winter break
- Put a cap on per grade and encourage group projects if needed
- Ensure that families are aware that it is not a school project, but its an at home project
- Cost between $100-500

Motion to approve a max of $500 for supplies

- Approved Ariana
- Second Kathleen

Talent Show

- Proposed date April 30th
- Need a secondary volunteer to help with the set up and running the gallery side of the art show
- Email if able to help

January event

- No notes

F. Other Business:

Approve Minutes from Previous meeting

- Approved. See above

Science Fair - date change

- Moved to Feb 5

Talent Show - date change

- Proposed for April 30th

Website update

- New calendar that can post to and parents are able to subscribe to
- On the Chicopee Hills website
- Send out messaging to parents - discussed weekly updates from the admin to keep parents in the loop

WRAPSC update

- Presentation on social media and smart phones at the school (hot topics)
- Talked about parent involvement committee – parents working together to support parent councils across the board / to help increase parent involvement in the schools

Pro Grant update

- Cannot pay for childcare with ProGrant

Children's Books on Mental Health

- About behaviour
- Author Joy Berry
- Another hot topic – how the school supports social and emotional well being

January Meeting

- Third week of January
- At this meeting, need to confirm fundraising goals / items

Contact email (chicopeehills.council@gmail.com)

Next meeting: **January 20, 2026 at 6:30**